

Morocco Motorcycle Tour 2026 — From Moraira to the Sahara

10 riding days through Morocco + Spanish transit — Rif, Middle Atlas, Sahara, Todra & Dades gorges, Aït Benhaddou, Marrakech and the High Atlas

Four bikes · 2× BMW R1200RS + 1× Honda GB350 + 1× Ténéré 700 World Raid · ferry Almería ↔ Nador · ± 2,500 km in Morocco · fully on tarmac · characterful riads & kasbahs.

Departure	Saturday 10 October 2026 — Moraira
Return	Wednesday 21 October 2026 — Moraira
Riding days in Morocco	10 (9 nights in Morocco)
Total door-to-door	± 12 days
Group	4 bikes — 2× BMW R1200RS, 1× Honda GB350, 1× Yamaha Ténéré 700 World Raid (23 L)
Crossing	Almería ↔ Nador (night ferry, ± 6–8 h)
Highest point	 Tizi n'Tichka pass — 2,260 m
Roads	Scenic tarmac roads; optional easy gravel for the World Raid only

The tour at a glance

Moraira → Almería (ferry) → Nador → Guercif → Midelt → Ifrane/Azrou → Merzouga (Sahara) → Todra & Dades → Aït Benhaddou → Marrakech → Ouzoud → Beni Mellal → Midelt → Nador (ferry) → Almería → Moraira

A grand loop from Moraira: a short run down the coast to Almería, the night ferry to Nador, then ten days through the very best of Morocco. From the green Middle Atlas with its cedar forests and Barbary macaques, down the Ziz Valley into the Sahara and the dunes of Erg Chebbi, through the spectacular Todra and Dades gorges, past the UNESCO kasbah of Aït Benhaddou, over the legendary Tizi n'Tichka pass to Marrakech, and back north via the Ouzoud waterfalls to the port.

Why October? The ideal month for Morocco: daytime 20–30 °C, comfortable desert temperatures, crisp mornings in the Atlas, little rain, clear skies and fewer tourists than in summer.

Our four bikes — group notes

We're riding **two BMW R1200RS**, **one Honda GB350** and **one Yamaha Ténéré 700 World Raid**. The route is deliberately planned **on tarmac**: the R1200RS is a road-focused sports-tourer, the GB350 a light, relaxed classic, and the World Raid, with its large tank, is built for long distances. Every stage is ridden entirely on tarmac; the odd gravel section is optional and only for the World Raid.

- 🐢 **Pace — the GB350 sets the rhythm.** The Honda GB350 (± 21 bhp) is the most relaxed of the group. On the long days (day 10: 335 km) and the high passes (Tizi n'Tichka, 2,260 m) it's the slowest → **allow a little extra time and stops, and don't ride away from the slowest bike**. This is a savour-it route, not a race.
 - 🛢️ **Fuel range & group stops.** The Ténéré 700 World Raid (**23 L**, ± 400 km) and the economical GB350 (± 15 L, ± 350 km) have ample range. The two **R1200RS** (± 18 L) realistically manage ± 300 km and therefore **set the fuel stops**: refuel together at ± 220 – 250 km, and never skip a station before a desert or mountain stage (days 4, 5 and 10).
 - 👥 **Riding in formation.** Ride in a staggered formation, with the slowest/least experienced rider at or near the front so nobody has to chase, and the last rider (sweep) keeps everyone together. Agree hand signals and a fixed regroup point (e.g. every junction/fuel stop).
 - 🛣️ **Tarmac & luggage.** The two R1200RS and the Honda GB350 are not made for loose gravel or pistes — so the whole group stays on the sealed road. The optional gravel sections (e.g. Cirque de Jaffar) are at most for the World Raid rider, and only in dry weather. Panniers/side cases are perfectly fine for this touring route; no soft sand.
 - 📄 **Documents × 4.** Each bike/rider needs their **own** set of papers (see border checklist). Green card + temporary Moroccan vehicle import per vehicle.
 - 🔧 **One shared set of tools + spares** is fine, but per bike carry: puncture-repair kit/pump, brake pads, chain lube (World Raid), and a set of fuses. Tyre sizes and oil differ per make.
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17 Itinerary (proposed)

Day	Date	Route	Distance
—	Sat 10 Oct	Moraira → Almería (transit) + night ferry	± 400 km
1	Sun 11 Oct	Nador → Guercif	202 km
2	Mon 12 Oct	Guercif → Midelt (N15)	238 km
3	Tue 13 Oct	Midelt → Ifrane → Azrou → Midelt (loop)	285 km
4	Wed 14 Oct	Midelt → Merzouga (Ziz Valley, Sahara)	285 km
5	Thu 15 Oct	Merzouga → Todra → Dades	275 km
6	Fri 16 Oct	Dades → Aït Benhaddou (R704)	215 km
7	Sat 17 Oct	Aït Benhaddou → Marrakech (Tizi n'Tichka)	195 km
8	Sun 18 Oct	Marrakech → Ouzoud → Beni Mellal	205 km
9	Mon 19 Oct	Beni Mellal → Midelt	285 km
10	Tue 20 Oct	Midelt → Nador + night ferry	335 km
—	Wed 21 Oct	Almería → Moraira (transit)	± 400 km

Dates are a proposal — adjust to the ferry times you book. Total in Morocco ± 2,520 km.

The crossing — Almería ↔ Nador

The ferry takes ± 6–8 hours across the Mediterranean. Ideally take a **night boat with a cabin** in both directions, so you don't lose a riding day and arrive in Nador fresh in the morning.

- **Booking:** [Baleària](#) or [Trasmediterranea/Naviera Armas](#) — choose **Almería → Nador** (not Melilla; Nador is in Morocco itself, while Melilla is Spanish and involves an extra border crossing).
- **Bike + cabin:** book an **outside cabin** and state that you're travelling with motorcycles (lashed down on the vehicle deck).
- **Arrival Nador:** port of **Beni Ansar**. Allow **1–2 hours** for border formalities (passport stamp + temporary vehicle import).
-  [Timetable & overview — Directferries](#)

 **Tip:** book the return (day 10, Nador → Almería) with some margin; arrive at the terminal at least **3 hours** before departure.

17 Day-by-day itinerary

Transit — Saturday 10 October: Moraira → Almería + night ferry

Route: Moraira → Almería (coast/inland) · **Riding time:** ± 4.5 h · **Distance:** ± 400 km

- A relaxed transit day along the Costa Blanca and Costa de Almería to the port. If you fancy it, take the last stretch inland (foothills of the Sierra Nevada) for some riding fun.
-  **Check in at Almería** and take the evening/night ferry to Nador. Sleep in the cabin; Morocco begins in the morning.

 [Almería port](#) ·  [Hotels near Almería port](#)

Day 1 — Sunday 11 October: Arrival Nador → Guercif

Route: Nador → towards Taza → Guercif · **Riding time:** ± 3.5 h (excl. border) · **Distance:** 202 km · **Road surface:** ★★★★★ · **Difficulty:** ★★☆☆☆

-  **Morning — border & Beni Ansar port.** Take your time over the formalities. Change some money (dirham) or use a card, buy a local SIM (Maroc Telecom/Orange) and fill up.
 [Nador](#)
-  **Rif foothills towards Guercif.** Ease into the Moroccan rhythm: first mountain panoramas, olive groves and the slowly drying landscape heading south.
-  **Overnight — Guercif.** Guercif is a practical staging town (not a tourist spot). Choose a tidy, simple hotel with parking for the bikes.
 [Hotels Guercif](#) ·  [Guercif](#)
-  **Dinner** · Simple local tagine or grilled specialities in the centre.

 A short, relaxed first day — deliberately so, as the border and getting used to the riding style and checkpoints take some energy.

Day 2 — Monday 12 October: Guercif → Midelt (N15)

Route: Guercif → N15 → Midelt · **Riding time:** ± 4 h · **Distance:** 238 km · **Road surface:** ★★★★★ · **Scenery:** ★★★★★☆

-  **The N15 — "quiet, flowing roads, perfect for a GS".** One of the favourite riding roads of the whole trip: little traffic, long flowing bends and a gradually climbing mountain landscape towards the High Plateaus.
 -  **Coffee stop en route** in a village café — a first taste of Moroccan road culture.
 -  **Overnight — Kasbah Asmaa, Midelt.** Characterful kasbah style with a palm garden and pool; an ideal base (we sleep here 3 nights in total: days 2, 3 and 9).
 [Kasbah Asmaa Midelt](#) ·  [Midelt](#)
 -  **Dinner** · At the kasbah — tagine, couscous or Berber specialities.
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🚲 Day 3 — Tuesday 13 October: Middle Atlas loop (Midelt → Ifrane → Azrou → Midelt)

Route: Midelt → Ifrane → Azrou (cedar forest) → Midelt · **Riding time:** ± 4.5 h · **Distance:** 285 km (loop) ·

Scenery: ★★★★★

A day *without luggage* — we leave the bags in Midelt and ride a beautiful loop through the greenest part of Morocco.

- 🌲 **Cedar forest near Azrou** · Vast cedar and pine forests; a good chance of wild **Barbary macaques** by the roadside.
📍 [Cèdre Gouraud / cedar forest](#) · 📷 [Photos](#)
- 🏔️ **Ifrane** · The surprising "Switzerland of Morocco" — alpine chalets, clean streets, small lakes. A perfect coffee stop.
📍 [Ifrane](#) · 📷 [Photos](#)
- 🐒 **Azrou** · Lively market town; a good lunch stop.
📍 [Azrou](#)
- 🏠 **Back to Kasbah Asmaa, Midelt** (night 2).

💡 The loop can be shortened; anyone who prefers a rest can explore Midelt and its surroundings (the Cirque de Jaffar piste is for the World Raid only — gravel, dry weather; the two RS stay on tarmac).

🚲 Day 4 — Wednesday 14 October: Midelt → Merzouga (Ziz Valley & the Sahara)

Route: Midelt → Errachidia → Ziz Valley (N13) → Erfoud → Merzouga · **Riding time:** ± 4.5 h · **Distance:** 285 km · **Scenery:** ★★★★★

- 🏞️ **Ziz Valley (N13)** · The great transition from mountains to desert: a green ribbon of tens of thousands of date palms between red-brown rock walls. Stop at the **Ziz viewpoint**.
📍 [Ziz Valley viewpoint](#) · 📷 [Photos](#)
- 🐪 **Arrival Erg Chebbi / Merzouga** · The first real sand dunes (up to ± 150 m high). Ride the final stretch towards the foot of the dunes.
📍 [Merzouga / Erg Chebbi](#) · 📷 [Photos](#)
- 🏠 **Overnight — kasbah/lodge by the dunes** · E.g. Riad Madu, Kasbah Tomboctou or a luxury **desert camp** in the dunes.
📍 [Lodges Merzouga](#)
- 🌅 **Sunset over the dunes** · Optional camel ride or quad; either way, climb a dune for sunset. The silence as the sun sets over the dunes is one of the highlights of the trip.

⚠️ **Sand!** Don't ride into the dunes on laden touring bikes. Park on firm ground at the lodge; the soft sand is for local guides/quads.

🚲 Day 5 — Thursday 15 October: Merzouga → Todra Gorge → Dades Gorge

Route: Merzouga → Rissani → Tinghir → Todra → Boumalne Dades · **Riding time:** ± 4.5 h · **Distance:** 275 km · **Scenery:** ★★★★★

- 🏠 **Rissani** · Old caravan town with a bustling souk (fine morning market on Sun/Tue/Thu).
[📍 Rissani](#)
 - 🌄 **Todra Gorge** · A breathtaking gorge with walls up to 300 m sheer above a narrow river. Ride through it and stop for photos and mint tea.
[📍 Todra Gorge](#) · 📷 [Photos](#)
 - 🏠 **Overnight — Dades Gorge** · E.g. **Chez Pierre** (small, gastronomic, a lovely setting) or Hotel Xaluca Dades.
[📍 Chez Pierre Dades](#) · 📍 [Boumalne Dades](#)
 - 🍽️ **Dinner** · Gastronomic at Chez Pierre or a tagine overlooking the gorge.
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🚲 Day 6 — Friday 16 October: Dades Gorge (R704) → Aït Benhaddou

Route: Dades hairpins (R704) → Boumalne → Ouarzazate → Aït Benhaddou · **Riding time:** ± 3.5 h · **Distance:** 215 km · **Scenery:** ★★★★★

- 📍 **Dades hairpins (R704)** · The ride leader's favourite road: a series of unforgettable hairpin bends snaking up the red rock wall. Ride a stretch up the gorge and back down the same road — these bends are worth riding twice.
[📍 Dades hairpins](#) · 📷 [Photos](#)
 - 🎬 **Ouarzazate** · "Hollywood of Morocco" (Atlas Studios); fill up here and have lunch.
[📍 Ouarzazate](#)
 - 🏠 **Aït Benhaddou (UNESCO)** · The famous mud-brick ksar — a backdrop for countless films (Gladiator, Game of Thrones). Arrive in the late afternoon for golden evening light.
[📍 Aït Benhaddou](#) · 📷 [Photos](#)
 - 🏠 **Overnight — kasbah overlooking the ksar** · E.g. **Kasbah Ellouze**, Riad Caravane or La Fibule d'Or.
[📍 Hotels Aït Benhaddou](#)
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🚲 Day 7 — Saturday 17 October: Aït Benhaddou → Marrakech (Tizi n'Tichka)

Route: Aït Benhaddou → Tizi n'Tichka (N9) → Marrakech · **Riding time:** ± 4 h · **Distance:** 195 km · **Highest point:** 2,260 m · **Scenery:** ★★★★★

- 🏔️ **Tizi n'Tichka pass (N9) — 2,260 m** · Classic High Atlas riding: endless bends over the highest tarmac pass of the trip. Recently widened and resurfaced — a joy to ride. Dress warmly; it's chilly at the top.
📍 [Tizi n'Tichka](#) · 📷 [Photos](#)
- 🍲 **Optional — Telouet** · The hidden kasbah of the Glaoui pasha, a short detour off the pass.
📍 [Kasbah Telouet](#)
- 🕌 **Arrival Marrakech** · Dive into the red city. **Note: busy traffic** on the medina's edge — ride defensively.
📍 [Marrakech — Jemaa el-Fna](#) · 📷 [Photos](#)
- 🏠 **Overnight — riad in the medina** · Choose a riad that arranges **secure parking** for the bikes (usually a car park just outside the medina).
📍 [Riads Marrakech](#)
- 🌃 **Evening — Jemaa el-Fna** · The famous square with food stalls, musicians and snake charmers.

P Bike tip Marrakech: don't ride into the narrow medina alleys. Park in a guarded car park (*gardien*) and continue on foot/by taxi. Ask the riad in advance for the best parking option.

🚲 Day 8 — Sunday 18 October: Marrakech → Ouzoud waterfalls → Beni Mellal

Route: Marrakech → Ouzoud → Beni Mellal · **Riding time:** ± 4 h · **Distance:** 205 km · **Scenery:** ★★★★★☆

- 💧 **Ouzoud waterfalls** · At 110 m, the highest waterfalls in Morocco; a green oasis with (again) Barbary macaques. A short walk to the foot, lunch with a view.
📍 [Ouzoud waterfalls](#) · 📷 [Photos](#)
- 🌿 **On to Beni Mellal** · Fertile landscape at the foot of the Middle Atlas.
- 🏠 **Overnight — Beni Mellal** · A practical staging town; choose a tidy hotel with parking.
📍 [Hotels Beni Mellal](#) · 📍 [Beni Mellal](#)

🚲 Day 9 — Monday 19 October: Beni Mellal → Midelt

Route: Beni Mellal → Khenifra → Middle Atlas → Midelt · **Riding time:** ± 4.5 h · **Distance:** 285 km · **Scenery:** ★★★★★☆

- 🌲 **Back into the Middle Atlas** · Wooded mountain roads and high plateaus; a calm, flowing ride towards Midelt.
- ☕ **Coffee/lunch** in Khenifra or en route.
📍 [Khenifra](#)
- 🏠 **Overnight — Kasbah Asmaa, Midelt** (night 3) · A familiar base before the long final day.
📍 [Kasbah Asmaa Midelt](#)

🚲 Day 10 — Tuesday 20 October: Midelt → Nador + night ferry

Route: Midelt → Missouri → Guercif → Taourirt → Nador · **Riding time:** ± 5.5–6 h · **Distance:** 335 km ·

Roads: N15 · N2 · **Difficulty:** ★★☆☆☆

The only day with an **early start** (± 07:30) — quiet roads, a cool morning and plenty of time to reach the ferry.

- ☕ **Coffee stop — Missouri** · One last Moroccan coffee; look back over the journey.
📍 [Missouri](#)
 - 🍴 **Lunch + 🛢️ fuel — Guercif** · A final traditional lunch (chicken tagine, fresh bread, mint tea). **Fill up here** — one less thing to worry about before the port.
📍 [Guercif](#)
 - 🚢 **Ferry Nador → Almería** · Be at the Beni Ansar terminal at least **3 hours** before departure. Documents ready (see checklist). Put the bike on its side stand, in first gear, take your tank bag/valuables with you and **photograph where it's parked** on the vehicle deck.
📍 [Nador port \(Beni Ansar\)](#)
 - 🌙 **Evening crossing** · Shower, dinner, look through the photos. On arrival in Almería, sleep over or ride on.
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🚗 Transit — Wednesday 21 October: Almería → Moraira

Route: Almería → Moraira · **Riding time:** ± 4.5 h · **Distance:** ± 400 km

A relaxed final stage along the coast back home. Home in Moraira.

Accommodation at a glance

Night	Place	Suggestion	Type	Indicative/night (2 pers)
Ferry	Almería→Nador	Ferry outside cabin	Cabin	€ 90–160 pp incl. bike
1	Guercif	Tidy town hotel	Simple	€ 30–60
2	Midelt	Kasbah Asmaa	Kasbah	€ 45–80
3	Midelt	Kasbah Asmaa	Kasbah	€ 45–80
4	Merzouga	Dune lodge / desert camp	Kasbah/camp	€ 50–140
5	Dades Gorge	Chez Pierre / Xaluca	Boutique	€ 60–110
6	Aït Benhaddou	Kasbah Ellouze etc.	Kasbah	€ 55–100
7	Marrakech	Riad in the medina	Riad	€ 70–160
8	Beni Mellal	Tidy town hotel	Simple	€ 35–70
9	Midelt	Kasbah Asmaa	Kasbah	€ 45–80
Ferry	Nador→Almería	Ferry outside cabin	Cabin	€ 90–160 pp incl. bike

 Prices are indicative (October 2026) and **not checked in real time**. In high season and around public holidays they can be higher — **book early** for Merzouga, Dades and Marrakech.

Indicative cost per bike/rider

Item	Indicative
Return ferry Almería↔Nador (bike + rider, cabin)	€ 260–420
9 nights Morocco (twin room shared → pp)	€ 250–500
Dinners + lunches + coffee (10 days)	€ 200–350
Fuel in Morocco (± 2,520 km)	€ 90–150
Fuel in Spain transit (± 800 km)	€ 60–90
Temporary vehicle import + border (free, plus copies)	€ 0–15
Motorcycle green-card cover for Morocco	€ 30–90
Entries, guides, tea, souvenirs	€ 80–200
Total per rider (indicative)	± € 1,000–1,800

Morocco is inexpensive on the ground; the biggest items are the ferry and fuel/travel.

Border & documents checklist (per bike × 4)

Make sure **each rider** carries these papers, complete and with copies:

-  **Passport** (still valid ≥ 6 months)
-  **Ferry booking confirmation** (outbound + return)
-  **Vehicle registration document (V5C logbook)** — in your own name, or a signed authorisation letter if not
-  **Driving licence** (UK photocard; an International Driving Permit is recommended)
-  **Insurance certificate / green card** with Morocco cover (check that Morocco is listed on your green card; if not, take out cover at the border on arrival)
-  **GB registration / UK number plate** clearly displayed (a "UK" sticker if your plate doesn't show it)
-  **Temporary vehicle import (D16 / Déclaration)** — filled in on entry; keep it safe, you hand it back on departure
-  Copies of everything (on paper + a photo on your phone)

 **Important:** on entry you receive a temporary import document per vehicle. **Don't lose it** — failing to hand it back on departure causes problems. Don't overstay the permitted period unintentionally.

Packing list — Morocco motorcycle trip (October)

Clothing & protection

- Motorcycle jacket + trousers with removable thermal lining (Atlas mornings are cold, the desert is hot)
- Waterproofs (low chance, but the Atlas can turn)
- Gloves: summer + mid-season
- Buff/neck tube against dust, sunglasses
- Light clothing for the evenings

Bike & technical

- Puncture-repair kit + mini pump/CO₂ per bike
- Basic tools, cable ties, tape, duct tape
- Spares: brake pads, fuses, chain lube (World Raid), bulb/LED
- Charging cables, power bank, phone mount, spare GPS cable if you have one
- Tie-downs (2 light straps for the ferry vehicle deck)

Personal

- First-aid kit, high-factor sun cream, anti-diarrhoea tablets, rehydration salts
- Cash (euros to change) + card; not everywhere takes cards
- Local SIM or eSIM
- Copies of documents, small change for tea/parking attendants

Mini Morocco handbook for the road

- **Checkpoints:** police/gendarmerie checks are normal. Stop calmly, greet, show your papers, smile. Usually you're waved through.
- **Speed:** in built-up areas often 40–60 km/h; speed cameras occur. Stick to the signs.
- **Fuel:** plenty in the north/cities; before desert and mountain stages (days 4, 5, 10) **always fill up**.
- **Water & food:** drink bottled water; tagine, couscous, brochettes and fresh mint tea are safe and delicious everywhere.
- **Money:** the dirham (MAD) can't be traded freely outside Morocco — change/withdraw locally and keep some cash for small villages.
- **Language:** Arabic + Berber; French is the second language. A few words of French/Arabic open doors.
- **Tips & guides:** a small tip for parking attendants (*gardien*) is customary (5–10 MAD).
- **Emergency numbers:** police **19**, gendarmerie (outside towns) **177**, ambulance **15**.

Loading the GPX into your Garmin Zümo XT / Kurviger

Best for Kurviger, Calimoto, TomTom etc.: use the **per-day files** in the `gpx-per-dag/` folder — one clean route per stage (5–8 via points), which import without the "too many markers" warning. The single

combined file `reisgids/Marokko_Motorreis_2026.gpx` is best for the Zümo XT (it also contains all the POI waypoints).

1. Connect the Zümo XT via USB (or use the **Garmin Tread / Drive** app) and copy the file to the **Garmin/GPX** folder.
2. On the Zümo: **Apps → Trip Planner / Routes** → import.
3. ⚙️ In **Settings → Navigation → Avoidances**, tick **Motorways** and **Toll roads** for the most scenic roads.
4. For **Kurviger**: open a per-day file via *Import GPX*; it loads as a route with a handful of waypoints you can drag to fine-tune.

💡 **Tip:** also works in **Komoot, OsmAnd, Apple Maps and Google My Maps**. In remote areas, load **offline maps** as a backup.

⚠️ Good to know

- **Book early:** Merzouga (dune lodges), Dades (Chez Pierre) and Marrakech (riads) fill up quickly in October. Book the **ferry** (outbound + return) early too.
- **Prices are indicative** (Oct 2026) and **not checked in real time** — always confirm when booking.
- **Riding times** exclude stops and assume scenic roads.
- **Don't lose the border document** (temporary vehicle import, per bike).
- **Desert = no soft sand on laden touring bikes.** Stay on firm ground; leave the dunes to guides/quads.
- **Return ferry:** in good time, documents ready, photograph where the bike is parked.

From the cedar forests of the Middle Atlas to the silence of the Merzouga dunes and the hairpins of the Dades — ten days you won't forget in a hurry. Safe travels and enjoy the ride. 🚲 ☀️ 🏜️